

## ENCOUNTERS

**RANGE:** Missile fire should be adjusted for the range between the attacker and the target. Missile fire at short range is adjusted by a bonus of +1 on the "to hit" rolls. Missile fire at medium range has no adjustment. Missile fire at long range is adjusted by a penalty of -1 on the "to hit" rolls.

**COVER:** "To hit" rolls for missile fire may be adjusted by the amount of cover a target has. A creature may hide behind any large object (a wall, tree, barrel, and so forth) to be "under cover". A target with "complete cover" cannot be hit (for example, a target around a corner). When a target has some cover but not "complete cover", the DM should make adjustments to missile fire to account for amount of cover. (Note that a shield is not considered as cover!) In general, the adjustments should be from -1 to -4. **EXAMPLE:** A character attacking a goblin partially hidden behind a small table would attack with a penalty of -1 on "to hit" rolls, while a character shooting at a bear in a thick woods might have a penalty of -4 on the "to hit" rolls.

**MAGICAL BONUSES:** If the DM uses magical arrows, bows, spears, or other magical weapons which might be used as missiles, any magical bonuses should be added to the "to hit" rolls for missile fire.

**OIL:** Oil (which is carried in small bottles called flasks) may be thrown as a missile weapon. It may also be spread on the floor of a dungeon and then lit. Burning oil will do 1-8 (1d8) points of damage to any creature in the flames (or who attempts to cross a pool of burning oil). Flaming oil will not harm a monster which normally uses a fire weapon (such as a red dragon). Fire will damage most **undead** monsters, such as skeletons, zombies, ghouls, and wights (though wights will only take 1/2 damage).

A flask of oil contains enough oil to make a pool 3' in diameter. A pool of burning oil will burn out in 1 turn. Oil thrown on a creature will drip off and will only cause damage for 2 rounds. The oil must be set afire for it to cause any damage; otherwise, it will only be slippery. The chance of oil catching fire depends on the situation, and is left for the DM to figure out. Touching the oil with a flaming torch should almost certainly cause the oil to light. Other methods may have less chance of success.

**HOLY WATER:** Holy Water must be kept in small, specially-prepared glass bottles (known as **vials**) for it to remain holy. For Holy Water to cause damage, it must be thrown (as a missile weapon) and successfully hit the target. The effect of a vial of Holy Water on an **undead** creature is the same as that of a flask of burning oil: 1-8 points of damage.

### Saving Throws

A saving throw represents the chance that a special attack may be avoided or will have less than the normal effect. This chance is given as a number on the **Saving Throws** chart (hereafter). A saving throw is made by rolling a twenty-sided die (1d20) (similar to "to hit" rolls). **If the result of the roll is equal to or greater than the number given on the chart, the saving throw is successful.** If the result is less than the number given, the saving throw is failed.

If a saving throw is successful against or versus a special attack which could cause damage, the victim will only take 1/2 damage from the attack. **EXAMPLE:** If a character makes a successful saving throw or "save" vs. a dragon's 20 point Breath, that character will only take 10 points of damage. If a saving throw is successful against a special attack that has a special effect but does not cause special damage such as Turn to Stone, the victim will avoid these special effects. **EXAMPLE:** A character who saves vs. a **charm person** spell is not affected by it.

## D&D: BASIC

Some attacks are both normal and special (damage plus poison, for example). In this case, even if the saving throw is successful, the attack will still do the normal damage unless noted otherwise; only the special attack is avoided. **EXAMPLE:** A rattlesnake bites for 1-4 points of damage *plus* poison. Even if a bitten character saves vs. Poison, he or she will still take 1-4 (1d4) points of damage from the bite.

If a poisoned attack hits a creature (such as the sting of a killer bee), the victim must save vs. Poison or die (unless the poison is neutralized; see the D&D EXPERT SET). The DM should not allow players to make use of poisoned weapons. If they want to use poisoned weapons, they are likely to meet opponents who also use them! Most characters of Lawful alignment would object to the use of poisoned weapons.

## SAVING THROWS

| Character Class       | Type of Attack      |             |                            |               |                         |
|-----------------------|---------------------|-------------|----------------------------|---------------|-------------------------|
|                       | Death Ray or Poison | Magic Wands | Paralysis or Turn To Stone | Dragon Breath | Rods, Staves, or Spells |
| Normal Man            | 14                  | 15          | 16                         | 17            | 17                      |
| Clerics               | 11                  | 12          | 14                         | 16            | 15                      |
| Dwarves and Halflings | 10                  | 11          | 12                         | 13            | 14                      |
| Elves                 | 12                  | 13          | 13                         | 15            | 15                      |
| Fighters              | 12                  | 13          | 14                         | 15            | 16                      |
| Magic-users           | 13                  | 14          | 13                         | 16            | 15                      |
| Thieves               | 13                  | 14          | 13                         | 16            | 15                      |

### Saving Throws for Higher Level Characters

In the D&D BASIC rules, all creatures and characters save only as their character class regardless of their level; there are no level adjustments for saving throws. In the D&D EXPERT rules however, saving throws are given for different levels of each character class. The DM may want to give creatures and NPCs with a level higher than 3 a bonus of +2 on all saving throws to reflect their greater skill and ability to save vs. special attacks. This should **not** be done if the D&D EXPERT rules are being used.

## MELEE COMBAT

Melee or hand-to-hand combat is the type of combat used when the enemy is within 5'. Hand-to-hand weapons include one-handed weapons (like a mace), two-handed weapons (like a battle axe), and any object the DM may allow to strike for damage (like a torch). Hand-to-hand attacks are adjusted by Strength, magical adjustments, and by positions (attacks from the rear).

Hand-to-hand weapons may be used to attack once per round. Monsters, however, are able to use all of their given attacks within one round of combat. A mountain lion would attack with two claws and one bite in the same round as a fighter's single sword attack.

**GROUP COMBAT:** One character or monster may be attacked by more than one opponent. The exact number is affected by the size of the combat area and the size of the monsters. **EXAMPLE:** When fighting in a 10' wide corridor, it is not likely that more than two or three characters could fight side by side.

**USING FIGURES:** Miniature figures are useful during combat for both the DM and the players, so that they may "see" what is happening. If miniatures are not being used, the DM should draw on a piece of paper, or use something (dice work nicely) to represent the characters in place of miniature figures.